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Cost of war comes home to New England consumers

By Dana Gerber, Sabrina Shankman, and Claire Thornton

GLOBE STAFF

The US-Israeli conflict with Iran is taking an increasing toll on New England consumers, as a snarled global oil supply chain has consumers paying dramatically more for gasoline and home-heating fuel than they were before the war broke out.

Average Massachusetts gasoline prices have risen nearly 40 cents over the past week, to about \$3.31 a gallon, according

Mixed message

Trump offered conflicting signals about the Mideast war. **A4.**

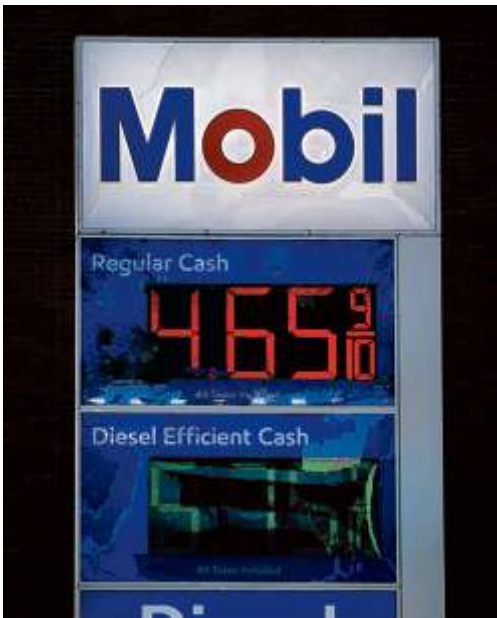
to AAA, after long hovering below the \$3 mark. Heating oil, likewise, climbed about 20 cents a gallon from the week of Feb. 23 to the week of March 2, according to state data, with colder temperatures poised to descend again on New England despite this week's spring-like respite.

While the price shock is already hurting consumers in the

short term, the ripple effects of those rapid cost hikes — which experts say could worsen if the war in Iran drags on — threaten to reignite broader inflation on everything from supermarket items to airfare to mortgage rates.

“Every day, it’s something new,” said Kaela Nurmi, an art conservator who filled up her tank at JP Oil on Monday. “You hope things can get better from here, but it doesn’t feel like it, and I’m just angry.”

COSTS, Page A5



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Average Massachusetts gas prices have risen nearly 40 cents over the past week.

Boston graduation rates reach new high

But city still trails state on diplomas in hand

By John Hilliard and Christopher Huffaker

GLOBE STAFF

High school graduation rates for Boston Public Schools reached a record high in 2025, ending a two-year slide, according to new state data.

But Massachusetts’ largest school district continues to lag behind the state as a whole in getting diplomas into the hands of seniors.

In Boston, 81 percent of students graduated high school in four years, about 8 percentage points below the state average, state data showed. Boston’s result was the highest recorded since 2006, when the state began tracking the data.

The statewide graduation rate was 1 percentage point below the record high of 90 percent in 2022.

Boston educators hailed the city’s record-breaking achievement.

“It’s a positive development if we’re getting more students to graduate,” said Marcus Walker, a humanities teacher at Fenway High School. “Our students can compete with anyone, and it’s a good thing.”

But Walker cautioned that the milestone didn’t erase other challenges faced by city schools.

“Can we do better? Yes, we can,” Walker said. “I’m trying to get better; I see my colleagues trying to get better.”

Mayor Michelle Wu, speaking at a press conference Monday at Dearborn STEM Academy in Roxbury, attributed the rise to several factors, including the increased number of Advanced Placement

GRADUATION RATES, Page B4

2025 HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATION RATES

Boston:

81%

Massachusetts:

89%

SPRING TRAINING



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

From left, Tim Morris and Bryan Calabrese, of South Boston, enjoyed the sunshine on M Street beach with a friend on his lunch break on Monday, the warmest day in Boston since Oct. 19. Drought conditions continue. **B1.**

Official praises nun who spoke out

Abuse report notes her effort to confront wrongs

By Edward Fitzpatrick

GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — In a scathing new report about clergy who sexually abused children in Rhode Island and the bishops who allowed that abuse to continue, one story stood out: a single nun who pushed back.

The nun not only confronted the priest who had nude pictures in his bedroom and nine “young men” living in his rectory, she also challenged the bishop who tried to keep her

quiet, telling him, “Assurances are not enough. To do nothing is to permit situations to continue.”

The 288-page report released last Wednesday identified 75 clergy in the Roman Catholic Diocese of Providence who were credibly accused of abusing more than 300 children between 1950 and 2011.

But the chronicle of appalling misconduct also includes the story of that one courageous nun.

The report did not identify the nun by name. But on Friday Attorney General Peter Neronha’s office identified her as Sister Mary

SISTER, Page A10

R.I. looks at its laws

The state’s lawmakers are considering a change to the statute of limitations for certain civil claims. **B1.**

In Concord, pondering a question of connection

Moving to boost cell service brings Thoreau to mind

By Billy Baker

GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD — On the one hand, Henry David Thoreau — who famously went to the woods here nearly two centuries ago because he “wished to live deliberately” — was a proponent of self-reliance. At the same time, he did not fully shun society or technology, and came to town regularly to visit friends and



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

A bronze likeness of Henry David Thoreau stood in deep snow at Walden Pond in Concord last week.

his mother.

So the question is: What would Thoreau think of the fact that Concord, in the year 2026, still has little to no cell coverage in vast swaths of the town? Would he find it great that people still need to rely on

themselves, or those around them, to navigate the world? Or would he find it foolish — the prevailing sentiment in town — and think people should have cell service, but just turn their phone off occasionally

CONCORD, Page A6

Departures hit Healey’s Cabinet

Top aides leave at faster pace than for predecessors

By Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

To understand the scope of the rapid-fire changes in Governor Maura Healey’s Cabinet, look no further than its website. As of Sunday afternoon, the state’s secretaries for education and housing were nowhere to be found. The biography of her new veterans services secretary — added weeks after his appointment was announced — was missing a photo. His predecessor was listed for weeks after he formally resigned.

Eight Cabinet members have departed Healey’s administration since she took office in 2023, including seven in the last year alone, in an unusually busy exodus ahead of a governor’s reelection bid.

Some said they wanted more time with their family, or simply fulfilled their promise to Healey to serve two or more years. Others migrated back to the private sector, far from the grind — and public scrutiny — of heading a state secretariat demands.

The departures from her 12-person Cabinet outpace those her last two predecessors weathered at this point in their first terms, including former governor Deval Patrick, who saw plenty of turnover at the top of his administration during his first term.

HEALEY, Page A10



Good for the sol

Tuesday: Partly sunny, warm. High: 61-66. Low: 42-47.

Wednesday: Cloudy. High: 52-57. Low: 47-52.

High tide: 4:36 a.m. 5:16 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:05 Sunset: 6:45

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

Two men were charged with attempting to support the Islamic State group after a homemade bomb was thrown at anti-Muslim protesters outside the New York City mayor’s residence. **A2.**

District Attorney Thomas M. Quinn III said his office will drop a domestic assault charge against Patriots defensive lineman Christian Barmore because they do not have a viable case. **B1.**

Point32 said it cut 100 employees, 2.3 percent of the Canton-based organization’s workforce. **D1.**

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